SOUL: IMMORTALITY, REBIRTH AND LIBERATION

CLAUSE AND MODAL QUESTION → SIX SURVIVAL TERMS → PERSON-MODELS AND IDENTITY → PLATO'S FOUR PROOFS → FIVE ARGUMENT FAMILIES → HINDU IMMORTALITY → KARMA → REBIRTH → BUDDHIST COUNTER-EXAMPLE → PARITY BENCH → VEDANTA → JAIN, NYAYA AND SAMKHYA-YOGA → PATHS AND THREE MEANS → RESURRECTION AND DETACHMENTS → ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final synthesis. Each card uses a layout chosen for its own content; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW | ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA | ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

STAGE 00 THE PRINTED CLAUSE AND THE MODAL QUESTION IT SETS

SOUL : IMMORTALITY; REBIRTH AND LIBERATION | IMMORTALITY = A SUBJECT IS DEATHLESS | REBIRTH = KARMICALLY RENEWED BECOMING | LIBERATION = EXIT FROM THE SERIES | IS EACH NECESSARY FOR THE NEXT? | 17 OWNED PARTS OF 112, 2018-2025 | HEAVIEST CLAUSE IN SECTION B | ANSWER IN MODAL VOCABULARY

IMMORTALITY -> REBIRTH -> LIBERATION

read forward = the substantialist implication · read against it = the Buddhist break

THE CLAUSE, VERBATIM

- Syllabus item 4, Paper II Section B: "Soul : Immortality; Rebirth and Liberation."
- Owned: survival arguments, identity criteria, school-specific continuity and every liberation terminus.
- Not owned: full Paper I self-metaphysics, faith-warrant, phenomenology of experience, karma as an answer to suffering.

THE THREE STEMS ACTUALLY SET

- Is immortality necessary for REBIRTH? — 2022 Q5(c), 2025 Q7(c).
- Are immortality and rebirth necessary for a robust LIBERATION? — 2024 Q6(a).
- Is immortality a basic PRESUPPOSITION of religion? — 2020 Q5(b).

WHY DESCRIPTION LOSES MARKS

- All three stems are modal; the words necessary, sufficient or neither must appear.
- A survey of school opinions answers a different question from the one printed.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The clause joins three separable claims, and the examiner tests the implication between them rather than the doctrines singly.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Immortality, rebirth and liberation are three separate claims joined by a disputed implication, and the whole value of this clause lies in refusing to let the words collapse.

STAGE 01 SIX SURVIVAL TERMS THAT ARE NOT SYNONYMS

IMMORTALITY | SURVIVAL | REBIRTH — THE WIDER TERM | REINCARNATION — SUBSTANCE REQUIRED | RESURRECTION — ONE LIFE | LIBERATION — SEVEN DESTINATIONS | punarjanma · punarbhava · samsara

TERM	CLAIM MADE	OWNER	FATAL MERGE
IMMORTALITY	a subject is deathless	Plato, Vedanta, Nyaya, Jainism	with resurrection
SURVIVAL	something continues after death	the weaker neutral claim	with immortality
REBIRTH	karmically renewed becoming	the only correct term for Buddhism	with reincarnation
REINCARNATION	a substantial soul re-enters flesh	Vedanta, Nyaya, Jainism	applied to Buddhism
RESURRECTION	God re-constitutes the person, ONE life	Judaism, Christianity, Islam	called rebirth in heaven
LIBERATION	exit from the series	every Indian school	treated as one state

WHY THIS BENCH IS THE CHEAPEST MARK

- Merging any two terms caps the script at roughly fifty per cent.
- Separating them in the opening two lines half-answers most stems in this clause.

THE SANSKRIT RANGE

- punarjanma (rebirth) · punaravrtti (return) · punarbhava (re-becoming) · samsara (the wandering itself).
- Reincarnation is a substantialist reading; rebirth is the neutral wider term.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The six terms differ in number of lives, mechanism, judge and identity-bearer, so no two of them may be exchanged.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Six words that look interchangeable make six different claims, and the opening move of every answer is to keep them apart.

STAGE 02 PERSON-MODELS AND THE FOUR IDENTITY CRITERIA

SUBSTANCE DUALISM | HYLOMORPHISM | BUNDLE / NO-SELF | EMBODIED PERSON | INDIAN SUBSTANTIAL SELF | BODILY · PSYCHOLOGICAL · SOUL · CAUSAL | NUMERICAL vs QUALITATIVE IDENTITY | WHAT IS THE CONTINUITY-BEARER?

FIVE MODELS, FIVE KINDS OF SURVIVAL

- Substance dualism: a disembodied soul persists; pressure = interaction and individuation.
- Hylomorphism: the soul is the form of a living body, so resurrection restores the person.
- Bundle / no-substantial-self: causal or psychological continuity replaces substance survival.
- Embodied person: survival requires resurrection or re-creation; pressure = replica and duplication.
- Indian substantial self (atman / jiva): transmigration is intelligible; pressure = absent memory.

FOUR CRITERIA, TWO DIFFERENT JOBS

- Bodily and psychological criteria answer HOW WE TELL; they fail at death and are circular respectively.
- Soul-substance and causal continuity answer WHAT MAKES IT SO; unobservable, or "neither same nor wholly other".
- Memory presupposes identity and cannot define it.

HICK'S REPLICA AND ITS OBJECTION

- A unique psychophysical replica with memory and character, appearing in a resurrection world, IS the person.
- Duplication objection: if God can make one replica, God can make two, and identity is one-to-one.
- Status control: a coherence defence of resurrection identity, never evidence that anyone survives.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each theory of the person makes a different kind of survival intelligible, so the identity question is prior to the survival question.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The survival debate is settled less by evidence about death than by a prior decision about what a person is.

STAGE 03 PLATO'S FOUR A PRIORI PROOFS AND THEIR CRITICS

OPPOSITES / CYCLICAL | RECOLLECTION (ANAMNESIS) | AFFINITY | FORM OF LIFE | SIMMIAS: SOUL AS HARMONIA | KANT: PARALOGISM | PRE-EXISTENCE ≠ SURVIVAL | 2023 Q6(a), 20 MARKS

ARGUMENT -> WHAT IT ESTABLISHES -> THE OBJECTION THAT FITS IT

four arguments = four mini-assessments, never one summary

THE FOUR ARGUMENTS AND THEIR EXACT YIELD

- Opposites: living and dead arise from each other, so souls persist — but degree-opposites are not being and non-being.
- Recollection: we judge sticks deficiently equal by a standard sense cannot supply — establishes PRE-EXISTENCE ONLY.
- Affinity: the soul resembles the invisible and stable — likeness, not identity; simplicity is assumed.
- Form of Life: what essentially brings Life cannot admit death — but fire does not become cold, it goes out.

THE OBJECTION INSIDE THE DIALOGUE

- Simmias: the soul is an attunement of bodily elements and perishes with the instrument.
- Plato replies twice: an attunement cannot pre-exist its instrument, and the soul RULES the body.
- The harmony objection is the ancient ancestor of every modern brain-dependence argument.

THE CRITIQUE FROM OUTSIDE

- Kant: the unity of apperception is a formal condition of thought, not knowledge of a substance.
- Immortality returns only as a postulate of practical reason — a relocation, not a refutation.
- Indian parallel: atman, jiva and the Nyaya self are eternal, but by scriptural and systematic routes.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each Platonic argument buys a different conclusion, so the directive "critically examine the proofs" requires four separate verdicts.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Plato offers four different attempts rather than one proof, and each must be asked separately what it actually establishes.

STAGE 04 FIVE ARGUMENT FAMILIES AND THE BURDEN SHIFT

SIMPLICITY | IDENTITY / CONTINUITY | MORAL ORDER | DESIRE / FULFILMENT | TESTIMONY AND EXPERIENCE | BODY / BRAIN DEPENDENCE | BURDEN SHIFTS, PROOF DOES NOT

FAMILY	CORE REASONING	MAIN OBJECTION
SIMPLICITY	a simple soul has no parts to decompose	simplicity unproved; a simple subject may still cease
IDENTITY	responsibility needs a persisting subject	continuity accounts do the same work
MORAL ORDER	complete justice exceeds one life	expresses moral hope, not demonstration
DESIRE	a deep natural desire points to an object	desires can be frustrated or socially formed
EXPERIENCE	contact with the dead or an eternal self	interpretation, diversity, alternatives

WHAT DEPENDENCE ACTUALLY DOES

- Memory, personality and agency vary systematically with bodily and cerebral conditions.
- This does NOT deductively prove that no subject survives.
- It DOES shift the burden: the survivalist owes accounts of interaction, individuation and identity.

THE GRADED CLAIM-LEVELS

- Demonstration: not available on any of the five families.
- Coherence: available on some models of the person. Presupposition: for some practices.
- Postulate: available to practical reason, which is Kant's relocation.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Every family fails in its own characteristic way, so the honest verdict grades the level of claim rather than rejecting the set.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The arguments for immortality are strongest as statements of what a moral life presupposes and weakest as demonstrations of what is the case.

STAGE 05 HINDU IMMORTALITY — VERSE SPINE AND FOUR SCHOOLS

GITA 2.22 GARMENTS | GITA 2.23 INDESTRUCTIBILITY | GITA 9.21 HEAVEN IS INSIDE SAMSARA | SUBTLE BODY IS NOT THE SELF | ADVAITA: NON-DUAL AWARENESS | VISISTADVAITA: ETERNAL JIVA | NYAYA: SUBSTANCE, NO CONSCIOUSNESS | SAMKHYA: PLURAL CONTENTLESS WITNESS

THE VERSE SPINE, USED PRECISELY

- 2.22 worn-out garments = rebirth. 2.23 weapons, fire, water and wind fail = indestructibility.
- 9.21 those who exhaust merit return: even heaven is a within-samsara stage.
- 5.4-5 convergence (balah, not panditah); 18.66 the surrender verse.
- Translations vary: paraphrase or cite a named translation. Never invent one.

FOUR ACCOUNTS OF WHAT IS DEATHLESS

- Advaita: non-dual awareness identical with Brahman; bondage is ignorance.
- Visistadvaita: an eternal individual soul, a mode (prakara) of God; communion, never absorption.
- Nyaya-Vaisesika: an eternal self-substance to which consciousness is ADVENTITIOUS.
- Samkhya-Yoga: purusa, plural and contentless, which strictly is never bound at all.

SUPPORTS AND THE STANDING OBJECTION

- Continuity of the knower across waking, dream and deep sleep; moral bookkeeping across a gap.
- Scriptural testimony (sabda) — name it as a presupposition rather than smuggling it in.
- Beginninglessness (anadi) blocks "when did the soul first fall?".
- Memory objection answered by dispositional rather than episodic continuity; warrant contested.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The tradition shares a conviction that the self is deathless while housing at least four incompatible accounts of what the deathless thing is.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: In the Hindu traditions immortality is not a reward that follows death but the standing nature of the self.

STAGE 06 KARMA — LEDGER, ADMINISTRATION AND POSTULATE TEST

ACT + UNSEEN POTENCY (ADRSTA / APURVA) | SANCITA — STORED | PRARABDHA — FRUCTIFYING | AGAMI — FUTURE | PURUSAKARA WITHIN DAIVA | SELF-REGULATING vs KARMADHYAKSA | REMOVAL TEST FOR POSTULATE STATUS | VICTIM-BLAMING CONTROL

PASSION-DRIVEN ACT -> UNSEEN POTENCY -> STORED / FRUCTIFYING / FUTURE -> MATURATION → effort works on agami, and through knowledge on sancita — never on prarabdha

THE THREEFOLD LEDGER AND WHERE FREEDOM LIVES

- Sancita: the accumulated store, destroyed by liberating knowledge.
- Prarabdha: the portion already ripening — this birth, this body, this span — and NOT cancelled by knowledge.
- Agami: what present action generates; the liberated agent accumulates none.
- Formula: effort (purusakara) within destiny (daiva); niskama-karma uses the law rather than escaping it.

WHO ADMINISTERS THE LAW

- Self-regulating in Buddhism, Jainism and Mimamsa: no judge is required.
- Superintended in Nyaya and the theistic Vedantas: God RATIFIES desert, never authors it.
- Naming this fork converts a description of karma into a philosophical answer.

POSTULATE TEST AND ITS PRICE

- Remove karma and four commitments fail: distribution, rebirth, liberation and ritual efficacy.
- Costs: unverifiability, victim-blaming risk, and the God-and-law problem.
- Replies: shared unverifiability, no licence for social judgement, God as administrator.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Karma is a law of moral causation whose threefold classification exists precisely to locate where present effort still operates.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Karma claims that the moral order is causal rather than administrative, so desert is discharged by the structure of the world.

STAGE 07 REBIRTH — THE FIT-PROBLEM AND ITS THREE EXITS

EXCEPTIONLESS MORAL LAW | ACTS DO NOT MATURE IN ONE LIFE | EXIT A: ABANDON THE CLAIM | EXIT B: ONE JUDGEMENT (SEMITIC) | EXIT C: WIDEN THE FIELD (INDIAN) | BEGINNINGLESSNESS (ANADI) | SUBTLE BODY CARRIES DISPOSITIONS | 2023 Q7(b) ASKS FOR FUNCTION

CLAIM: every act matures -> FACT: many do not, within one life -> THREE EXITS -> REBIRTH IS EXIT C

WHAT REBIRTH CONTRIBUTES

- Preserves an exceptionless moral law against the evidence of unmatured desert.
- Explains initial inequality: birth-conditions are consequences, not impositions.
- Secures beginninglessness, so no original fault must be explained as in a Fall narrative.
- Gives liberation its content by supplying something to be freed from.

VEHICLES OF CONTINUITY, SCHOOL BY SCHOOL

- Advaita and Visistadvaita: the subtle body (suksma-sarira) with mind, senses and breath.
- Nyaya-Vaisesika: the eternal self bearing unseen potency (adrsta).
- Samkhya-Yoga: linga-sarira — strictly it is PRAKRTI that transmigrates, not purusa.
- Jainism: the jiva with adhering karmic matter. Buddhism: causal conditioning, no vehicle-substance.

COSTS THE ANSWER MUST CONCEDE

- The regress explains each birth by an earlier one and never the series as a whole.
- No past-life memory; and the moral hazard of reading suffering as evidence of fault.
- Gita 9.21: even heaven is a within-samsara stage, not an exit.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Rebirth is the exit that keeps an exceptionless moral law from being falsified by the visible facts of a single lifetime.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rebirth is not an ornament on karma theory but its enabling condition, the widened field in which desert can mature.

STAGE 08 THE BUDDHIST COUNTER-EXAMPLE AND THE MODAL VERDICT

ALL CONDITIONED FACTORS IMPERMANENT | NO AGGREGATE IS A SELF (ANATMAN) | CRAVING AND FORMATIONS CONDITION | CONTINUITY WITHOUT AN OWNER | FLAME TO FLAME — ILLUSTRATION ONLY | NEITHER SAME NOR WHOLLY OTHER | SUFFICIENT, NOT NECESSARY | SK 62-63: PRAKRTI TRANSMIGRATES

(1) IMPERMANENCE -> (2) NO SELF AMONG THE AGGREGATES -> (3) CRAVING CONDITIONS -> (4) REBIRTH WITHOUT AN OWNER → one counter-example defeats a necessity claim

WHAT IS DENIED AND WHAT IS NOT

- Denied: an unchanging, independent, permanent self that owns experiences and transmigrates intact.
- NOT denied: the conventional person, moral consequence, causal descent, or rebirth itself.
- Anatman is a middle course between an eternal self and annihilation — it is not nihilism.

THE OWNERSHIP OBJECTION AND ITS RESIDUE

- If no same agent persists, who receives the karmic fruit?
- Reply: responsibility rests on causal connectedness, not identity of substance.
- Residue to concede: critics answer that causal descent may be thinner than ownership.

THE VERDICT, IN THE EXAMINER'S VOCABULARY

- Substantialist systems say YES; Buddhism says NO; one counter-example settles it.
- An immortal soul is SUFFICIENT for rebirth but NOT NECESSARY.
- What rebirth requires is a continuity-bearer; the dispute is whether that bearer must be a substance.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Buddhism holds together a denial of any permanent self and a full doctrine of rebirth, which is exactly what a necessity claim forbids.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Buddhism is the decisive counter-example because it secures re-becoming through causal continuity while denying a permanent self.

STAGE 09 THE LIBERATION PARITY BENCH — SEVEN DESTINATIONS

MOKSA — IDENTITY (ADVAITA) | MOKSA — COMMUNION (VISISTADVAITA) | APAVARGA — NO CONSCIOUSNESS | KAIVALYA — CONTENTLESS ISOLATION | JAIN PERFECTED OMNISCIENCE | NIRVANA — CRAVING EXTINGUISHED | RESURRECTION — EMBODIED, BEFORE GOD | KEVALA ≠ KAIVALYA

TERM	SCHOOL	WHAT ENDS	WHAT REMAINS	CONSCIOUSNESS?
MOKSA	Advaita	ignorance (avidya)	Brahman alone	YES, self-luminous
MOKSA	Visistadvaita	karmic bondage	eternal jiva with God	YES, personal
APAVARGA	Nyaya-Vaisesika	pain and its conditions	the self-substance	NO, and no bliss
KAIVALYA	Samkhya-Yoga	non-discrimination	purusa, isolated	YES, contentless
SIDDHAHOOD	Jainism	karmic matter	perfected omniscient jiva	YES, four infinitudes
NIRVANA	Buddhism	craving and ignorance	not stated as a self	neither survival nor annihilation
RESURRECTION	Semitic	death	the embodied person	YES, before God

THE FOUR QUESTIONS THE BENCH ANSWERS

- Identity, communion, cessation, isolation or perfection — which one is meant?
- Is individuality preserved? Sublated only in Advaita.
- Is consciousness present? Absent only in Nyaya apavarga.
- Is it attainable while alive? Yes in Advaita and in Samkhya-Yoga.

POSITIVE PERFECTION vs MERE CESSATION

- Advaita and Jainism are fulfilment-rich; Nyaya is cessation-only; Buddhism refuses both extremes.
- Objection: cessation-only liberation is unattractive. Reply: Nyaya offers freedom FROM suffering, not luxury.
- Terminological trap: Jain kevala means OMNISCIENCE; Samkhya kaivalya means CONTENTLESS ISOLATION.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Seven destinations share one English word while differing in what ends, what remains and whether consciousness is present at all.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Liberation is a family-resemblance term rather than the name of a state, and the apparent Indian consensus is a shared vocabulary over incompatible ends.

STAGE 10 VEDANTA — ONE FORK, AND EMBODIED LIBERATION

BONDAGE = IGNORANCE (ADVAITA) | BONDAGE = KARMA AND DEPENDENCE | REMOVAL MODEL -> KNOWLEDGE ALONE | ATTAINMENT MODEL -> DEVOTION AND GRACE | JIVANMUKTI NOW | PRARABDHA SUSTAINS THE BODY | VIDEHAMUKTI AT THE BODY'S FALL | REACHES GOD, NEVER BECOMES GOD

ADVAITA — REMOVAL, AND PRESENT FREEDOM

- Bondage is a cognitive error, so release is not produced; freedom is eternally accomplished (siddha).
- Only knowledge removes ignorance, as light removes darkness; Samkara rejects jnana-karma-samuccaya-vada.
- Preparation: citta-suddhi, sadhana-catustaya, then sravana-manana-nididhyasana.
- Jivanmukti now; the body continues by prarabdha — the potter's wheel after the hand withdraws.

VISISTADVAITA — ATTAINMENT, AND A REAL SOUL

- The jiva is an eternal individual, a mode (prakara) of God, real and never absorbed.
- Means: karma purifies, jnana discloses, bhakti as dhruvanusmrti is direct, prapatti is the accessible alternative.
- Liberation is communion and service, given finally by grace.

THE REAL-AGENT QUESTION, PRICED BOTH WAYS

- Advaita: at the ultimate level there is no agent, no bondage and no one literally liberated.
- Visistadvaita: an unreal agent cannot strive, love or be rewarded, so the jiva must be real.
- Each pays a price — a real discipline for a superimposed agent, or total dependence for a distinct soul.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Tell me what a school takes bondage to be and its conception of release, along with its permitted means, follows immediately.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Vedantic dispute is not about how liberation is reached but about what is left when it is reached.

STAGE 11 JAIN LADDER AND THE TWO AUSTERE TERMINI

KASAYA -> ASRAVA -> BANDHA | SAMVARA -> NIRJARA | KEVALA-JNANA MANIFESTS | ANANTA-CATUSTAYA | NYAYA: FALSE KNOWLEDGE CHAIN | APAVARGA WITHOUT CONSCIOUSNESS | SK 62-63 MISATTRIBUTION | YS 1.24 ISVARA IS NOT A CREATOR

PASSIONS -> INFLOW -> BONDAGE -> STOPPAGE -> SHEDDING -> OMNISCIENCE -> SIDDHAHOOD

FALSE KNOWLEDGE -> DEFECT -> ACTIVITY -> BIRTH -> SUFFERING, reversed by true knowledge

JAINISM — SOUL AND BONDAGE, BOTH NOUNS

- The jiva is eternal, conscious, uncreated, with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and energy.
- It is co-extensive with the body it occupies: extension is a MODE of the soul during bondage.
- Karma is quasi-material (karma-pudgala), analysed by nature, duration, intensity and quantity.
- Image: dust clings to an oily body — the oil is passion. Interaction objection answered by modal extension.

NYAYA-VAISESIKA — CESSATION, HONESTLY STATED

- Cutting the chain at false knowledge unwinds defect, activity, birth and suffering.
- Consciousness is ADVENTITIOUS, so apavarga leaves the self-substance without awareness or bliss.
- Objection: indistinguishable from insentience. Reply: the school offers the end of a defect, not a reward.

SAMKHYA-YOGA — ISOLATION, NOT BLISS

- SK 1 threefold suffering; satkaryavada; SK 62-63 no purusa is bound, released or transmigrating.
- SK 67 potter's wheel; SK 68 videha-kaivalya. Liberation is viveka-khyati, an epistemic correction.
- YS 1.2 citta-vrtti-nirodha; 2.3 five klesas; 1.24 Isvara a special purusa; 4.34 kaivalya as pratiprasava.
- Objections: individuation of plural purusas, prakrti's purpose, and the desirability of a contentless end.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Three schools derive three different termini strictly from three different diagnoses of what has gone wrong.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jain perfection, Nyaya cessation and Samkhya isolation are three refusals to promise more than each metaphysics can honestly deliver.

STAGE 12 PATHS TO LIBERATION AND THE THREE-MEANS DISPUTE

NAVADHA BHAKTI — BHAGAVATA 7.5.23 | GITA 18.66 · 9.22 · 9.32 | VAIDHI vs RAGANUGA | SAGUNA vs NIRGUNA | MARJARA vs MARKATA NYAYA | SAKSAT-SADHANA vs ARAD-UPAKARAKA | PRODUCTION vs REMOVAL MODEL | KARMA QUALIFIES · BHAKTI RECEIVES · JNANA REMOVES

DEVOTION, EVALUATED RATHER THAN DESCRIBED

- Nine limbs in order: sravana, kirtana, smarana, pada-sevana, arcana, vandana, dasya, sakhya, atma-nivedana.
- Ramanuja: dhruvanusmrti plus prapatti, grace decisive. Madhva: jnana-purvaka-sneha, prasada decisive.
- Vallabha: pusti-marga. Caitanya: prema as a fifth purusartha. Advaita: preparatory citta-suddhi only.
- Incapacity argument: a beginninglessly bound jiva cannot lift itself, so grace must be received.

THE DISAGREEMENT, NAMED NOT HARMONISED

- Purva-Mimamsa: karma alone, since the Veda is essentially injunctive.
- Samkara: moksa is siddha not sadhya, so only knowledge removes ignorance.
- Ramanuja: karma purifies, jnana discloses, bhakti is the direct means, prapatti the accessible alternative.
- Gita 5.4-5 licenses convergence, which is why Samkara, Ramanuja and Tilak could each claim the text.

OBJECTIONS AND THE HONEST REPLY

- Love presupposes duality, so devotion cannot deliver Advaitic identity — Advaita agrees and calls it a means.
- Convergence is diplomatic mush — reply: they converge in FUNCTION and diverge in TERMINUS.
- If grace decides, effort is otiose — the cat and monkey dispute is the tradition's own statement of the problem.
- Nirguna bhakti shows a personal FOCUS suffices, but the objection stands against strictly non-theistic systems.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Which means is direct is settled by a prior metaphysical question, namely whether liberation is produced or merely uncovered.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Devotion relocates liberation from achievement to reception, and the three-means quarrel is really a quarrel about production versus removal.

STAGE 13 RESURRECTION, REBIRTH AND THE ANTI-THEISTIC DETACHMENTS

CULLMANN 1955: OPPOSED, NOT COMPLEMENTARY | ONE LIFE vs BEGINNINGLESS SERIES | GAP AND RE-ASSEMBLY PROBLEMS | AQUINAS · VAN INWAGEN · HICK | MEMORY OBJECTION | KARMA WITHOUT A JUDGE | REBIRTH WITHOUT A SOUL | NASTIKA = VEDA-REJECTING, NOT ATHEIST

GREEK IMMORTALITY | HEBREW RESURRECTION -> psychosomatic unity requires a divine act → JAINISM removes the GOD, keeps the SOUL -> BUDDHISM removes the SOUL, keeps REBIRTH -> the whole structure is separable

THE COMPARATIVE GRID

- Lives: one earthly life against a beginningless series. Mechanism: divine act against karmic maturation.
- Judge: God in a final judgement against the law itself, which Nyaya and Ramanuja have God ratify.
- Telos: restored embodied communion against exit from the series. Time: linear against cyclical with an exit.
- Body: essential, a spiritual body still a body, against discarded clothing with a dispositions-bearing subtle body.

IDENTITY FAILS ON BOTH SIDES

- Resurrection: the gap problem, and the re-assembly or cannibal objection about shared matter.
- Aquinas secures continuity by form; van Inwagen preserves the body and leaves a simulacrum; Hick offers a unique replica.
- Duplication objection: if one replica, why not two? Rebirth faces the mirror-image memory objection.
- Reincarnation presupposes substance; rebirth does not, and Gita 9.21 keeps even heaven inside the series.

THREE DETACHMENTS AND THEIR HARD LIMIT

- Karma without a judge answers distribution without theodicy; rebirth without a soul defeats the necessity claim.
- Liberation without grace shows soteriology is not intrinsically theistic.
- Counter-pressures: a law without a legislator, unclear moral ownership, attainability without grace.
- Limit: the conclusion is DETACHABILITY, never a disproof of theism.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Resurrection and rebirth answer different questions, and the anti-theistic traditions show the whole karmic structure detachable from both judge and substance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Resurrection asks how an essentially embodied person can survive, while rebirth asks how desert can be discharged when one life is too short.

STAGE 14 ANSWER ARCHITECTURE, TRAPS AND THE GRADED VERDICT

DIRECTIVE DECODER | MODAL VERDICT IN THE STEM'S WORDS | FIX THE LIBERATION TERM FIRST | CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION | 10m ~150w · 15m ~250w · 20m ~300w | FOURTEEN STANDING TRAPS | STATE WHAT WOULD FALSIFY YOUR POSITION | QUOTATION DISCIPLINE

DECODE THE DIRECTIVE -> CHOOSE THE BANDED STRUCTURE -> OPEN WITH A DISTINCTION -> CLOSE WITH A GRADED VERDICT

DIRECTIVE DECODER, ABBREVIATED

- Necessity stems demand necessary / sufficient / neither, in those words.
- Named-text stems demand that text's verses; "critically examine the proofs" demands separate assessments.
- Two-verb stems carry two equally weighted obligations; "evaluate as a pathway" demands a criterion first.
- "Essential postulate" demands the removal test; "how far plausible" demands a graded verdict.

THE TRAPS THAT COST MARKS EVERY YEAR

- Merging immortality, resurrection and rebirth; saying Buddhism denies continuity; making apavarga blissful.
- Using the flame as proof; letting knowledge destroy prarabdha; calling bhakti mere emotion.
- Saying Advaita rejects bhakti; answering the three-means stem with "all three are equal".
- Conflating rebirth with reincarnation; calling Yoga's Isvara a creator; saying purusa is bound and released.

THE VERDICT LADDER AND ITS TEMPLATES

- Weak merges the schools; average defines them; good names the continuity-bearer; strong gives the modal verdict.
- Top adds a discriminating distinction and a falsification statement.
- Necessity template: sufficient but not necessary, because rebirth requires a continuity-bearer.
- Liberation template: the term names a family, not a state, once the four termini are separated.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The marks in this clause lie in what a script refuses to merge, so every answer opens with a distinction and closes with a graded verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: In this clause the examiner buys precision about what must not be merged, and rewards a verdict that states its own falsification condition.

EXTRA OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH — ENRICHMENT ONLY

SUBSTANCE vs PSYCHOLOGICAL vs CAUSAL | MEMORY OBJECTION AT FULL STRENGTH | PERFECTION vs CESSATION IDEALS | PRARABDHA PRESSED FURTHER | INDIVIDUATION OF PLURAL PURUSAS | GRACE AND EFFORT AS STRUCTURE

WHAT THIS NODE ADDS

- Three rival theories of persistence stated as competitors rather than as school labels.
- The prospective form of the memory objection, and the dispositional reply with its evidential silence.
- Fulfilment-rich against cessation-only ideals, and the argument that promising less may be more honest.
- The sharpened jivanmukti objection, and Samkhya's different explanation of the same phenomenon.

WHAT MUST NOT BE OVER-STUDIED

- Teleportation and brain-split thought experiments, and fringe reincarnation case literature.
- None of these appears in the seventeen owner questions, and importing them displaces examined material.
- Promotion trigger: only if UPSC directly asks about memory and identity criteria.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This enrichment node is unnecessary for a competent core answer and never repairs a missing core doctrine, distinction or verdict.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels